

Jackson Clark

PUBLICATIONS

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- Clark, J., Y. Su, S. M. R. Pial, L. Gniedziejko, and T. Xu (2026). “SREGym: A Live Training Ground for AI SRE Agents with High-Fidelity Failure Drills”. In: *Conference on AI Systems (CAIS), Demo Track*.
- Clark*, J., Y. Su*, S. M. R. Pial, Y. Tian, L. Gniedziejko, H.-A. Jacobsen, Y. Chen, and T. Xu (May 2026). “SREGym: A Live Benchmark for AI SRE Agents with High-Fidelity Failure Scenarios”. In: *arXiv:2605.07161*. Supported by a Laude Institute Slingshot Grant. arXiv: 2605.07161.
- Chen*, Y., J. Pan*, J. Clark*, Y. Su*, N. Zheutlin, B. Bhavya, R. Arora, Y. Deng, S. Jha, and T. Xu (2025). “STRATUS: A Multi-agent System for Autonomous Reliability Engineering of Modern Clouds”. In: *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*. Accepted. arXiv: 2506.02009 [cs.DC].
- Jha*, S., R. Arora*, Y. Watanabe, T. Yanagawa, Y. Chen, J. Clark, et al. (2025). “ITBench: Evaluating AI Agents across Diverse Real-World IT Automation Tasks”. In: *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*. Oral Presentation (Top 1%). arXiv: 2502.05352 [cs.AI].

AWARDS

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- **Laude Institute Slingshot Grant for SREGym** 2025

EXPERIENCE

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|---|---------------------------------------|
| Microsoft Research | Redmond, WA (Onsite, Full-Time) |
| Research Intern, Agentic Innovation | Summer 2026 |
| – Making agents more reliable. | |
| University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign | Urbana, IL (Onsite, Full-Time) |
| Graduate Research Assistant, xLab | Fall 2024 – Present |
| – Building the AI for production stack. | |
| – Leading SREGym , a live benchmark for AI SRE agents with high-fidelity failure scenarios, supported by a Laude Institute Slingshot Grant (2025). | |
| – Co-authored STRATUS (NeurIPS 2025) and ITBench (ICML 2025, Oral, Top 1%); lead maintainer of AIOpsLab (800+ GitHub stars). | |
| NASA Marshall Space Flight Center | Huntsville, AL (Onsite, Full-Time) |
| Software Engineer Intern, Huntsville Operations Support Center (HOSC) | Summer 2023 |
| – Developed a forward error correction library in C++ based on CCSDS standards (BCH, LDPC, and convolutional codes) for NASA’s GPDM mission. | |
| – Contributed to software automation tools supporting flight controllers. | |
| NASA Ames Research Center | Mountain View, CA (Remote, Full-Time) |
| Research Intern, Intelligent Systems Division | Summer 2023 |
| – Led reinforcement learning research for multi-agent pathfinding (MAPF) in urban air traffic management, leveraging Python, PyTorch, TensorFlow, and Docker on a supercomputing cluster. | |
| NASA Goddard Space Flight Center | Greenbelt, MD (Remote, Part-Time) |
| Software Engineer and Data Science Intern, HEASARC | Fall 2022 – Spring 2023 |
| – Spring Project: Trained ML models (scikit-learn, TensorFlow) to classify neutron star spectra using NICER payload data. | |
| – Fall Project: Redesigned SkyView, a React + Flask data catalog system for querying astrophysics datasets by sky position. | |
| NASA Marshall Space Flight Center | Huntsville, AL (Onsite, Full-Time) |
| Software Engineer Intern, Payload Operations Integration Center | Summer 2022 |
| – Designed an automation tool for ISS flight controllers to streamline timeline change processes. | |

INVITED TALKS

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- **SREGym** Spring 2026
Microsoft Research, System Intelligence Seminar.
 - **STRATUS** March 17, 2026
University of Toronto, ECE1770. Hosted by Yifang Tian and Hans-Arno Jacobsen.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	Urbana, IL
Ph.D. Computer Science	Fall, 2024–Present
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	Urbana, IL
B.S. in Information Sciences + Data Science, GPA: 3.82/4.00	2020–Spring, 2024

TEACHING

• Instructor at Discovery Partner's Institute	Summer 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026
Designed and taught a 2 week Data Science Intensive program to educate Chicago Public School teachers to create their own data science lessons for their classrooms.	
• Course Assistant at UIUC	Spring 2023 - Spring 2024
<i>Data Science Discovery (CS 107)</i>	